



My Tekion Interview Experience

Backend Developer Role

About Tekion

Tekion Corp is a cloud technology company founded in 2016 by former Tesla CIO Jay Vijayan. The company is headquartered in Pleasanton, California, with Asia-Pacific operations including a major technology center in Chennai, India.

The company's flagship platform, **Automotive Retail Cloud (ARC)**, is an end-to-end, cloud-native solution designed for automotive dealerships. It integrates multiple modules such as Customer Relationship Management (CRM), Dealer Management System (DMS), digital retail, service management, parts, analytics, and AI-powered insights.

In 2022, Tekion also introduced the **Automotive Enterprise Cloud (AEC)**, a unified digital ecosystem that enables vehicle purchases directly from OEM brand websites through dealerships. It offers configurator tools, e-signature options, online payments, and advanced analytics—bridging the gap between manufacturers and dealerships.

My Interview Process and Experience

The Tekion recruitment process I went through was structured across five main stages. Each round had a distinct purpose, focusing on different skill sets.

Round 1: Online Assessment

This was the initial shortlisting stage I took online. It included:

- 8 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) covering DBMS, Operating Systems, and Data Structures & Algorithms (DSA).
- 1 medium-level coding question (example: split-array pattern problem).
- 1 SQL query-based problem to test database knowledge.

From this round, approximately 50 candidates including myself were shortlisted for the next stage.

Round 2: Offline Coding Round

The second round I attended took place in an offline setting with two categories of tasks:

- **Frontend Task:** I had to build a form interface supporting multiple input types, a preview option, and JSON export functionality. My implementation was around 90% complete.
- **Backend Tasks:** I solved algorithmic problems such as the “Buy and Sell Stock” optimization and a visitor log analysis problem.

About 20 candidates including myself advanced to the next stage.

Round 3: Offline Coding (DSA-Focused)

This stage tested my algorithmic thinking and problem-solving speed. The problems I encountered included:

- Word break / dictionary segmentation problem.
- Prefix sum variant requiring optimized cumulative computations.

Although I attempted brute-force solutions, I managed to qualify along with 10 other candidates for the technical interviews.

Round 4: Technical Interview

This round focused on hands-on and experience-based technical discussions rather than purely theoretical questions. Key areas I discussed were:

- Detailed exploration of my past projects, such as my internship experience at Citi and hackathon participation.
- Comparisons between frameworks (e.g., Apache Camel vs. Spring Boot) based on my experience.
- Code snippet debugging and analysis that I worked through with the interviewer.
- Proof-of-concept (POC) designs and Redis-based caching implementations I had worked on.
- Designing agents and microservices for real-world scenarios based on my understanding.

Out of 11, only 5 candidates, including myself, progressed to the HR round.

Round 5: HR Interview (Final Round)

The HR discussion I had revolved around personality, company fit, and career aspirations. Questions I was asked included:

- “What do you know about Tekion and why do you want to join?”
- My internship learnings, hackathon takeaways, and teamwork experiences.
- My favorite projects and opinions on current AI trends.
- My thoughts on pros and cons of live coding rounds and how I approach stress situations.

At the end of this round, all 5 of us received final offers.

My Final Offer

The offer I received consisted of:

- A 6-month internship.
 - Conversion to Full-Time Employment (FTE) upon successful completion.
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Key Suggestions and Tips from My Experience

Technical Preparation

- Master all projects and technologies listed on your resume - I was thoroughly questioned about everything on mine.
- Prioritize problem patterns on LeetCode over solving hundreds of problems randomly - this approach helped me significantly.
- Build impactful real-world projects and actively participate in hackathons - my hackathon experience was a major talking point.
- Gain familiarity with modern backend stacks and core AI/ML fundamentals - these came up frequently in my technical discussions.

Interview Strategy

- Clear communication often outweighs incomplete technical answers - I found this to be crucial.
- Be honest and composed—admitting uncertainty is better than guessing, which I learned during my interviews.
- Relate algorithms and technical knowledge to practical, real-world scenarios - this impressed my interviewers.
- Remember, preparation outweighs luck in the long run - my thorough preparation made all the difference.

Mindset

- Prioritize quality over quantity in problem-solving - this approach served me well.
- Focus on learning deeply through projects, not just theoretical study - my hands-on experience was highly valued.
- Stay adaptable and curious about evolving technologies - this mindset helped me in discussions.
- Confidence grows with hands-on practice and self-driven learning - I experienced this first-hand.

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Best of luck for your journey!